PROJECT CHARTER

Project Title	Smart Parking Platform			**Project Manager**	Sean Bar-Tal
Project Start Date	September 4, 2026	**Project End Date**	December 4, 2026	**Project Sponsor**	City of Houston Public Transportation Department

Business Need

Houston drivers lose time searching for parking, increasing congestion and frustration. Parking operators need better tools to manage occupancy, pricing and utilization. Sponsored by the City of Houston Public Transportation Department, WE ARE $oftware ¢orp. will develop a web and mobile platform for finding, reserving, navigating to and paying for parking.

Project Scope	Deliverables
Develop and deploy web and mobile applications with secure accounts, real-time availability, searchable maps, reservations and extensions, digital payments, receipts/refunds, notifications and navigation. Provide parking operators with an administrative dashboard, inventory and pricing controls, and occupancy and revenue reporting. Excluded: facility construction/operation, sensor manufacture/installation, cash processing, citation enforcement, autonomous parking and ownership of external services.	1. Web and mobile parking applications supported by secured backend APIs and a database. 2. Integrated parking availability, mapping/navigation, payment and notification services. 3. Operator dashboard with parking, pricing, reservation and reporting controls. 4. Requirements, architecture, project plans and competitive analysis. 5. Tested release, acceptance results, deployment configuration and operating/support documentation.

Risks and Issues	Assumptions / Dependencies
Stale occupancy data or concurrent requests can cause invalid or duplicate bookings. Validate timestamps and use transactions and booking constraints. External APIs may fail or change. Test integrations, monitor services and define retries and fallbacks. Security/privacy failures, scope growth and late integration may delay launch. Apply access controls, baseline scope and review risks weekly. Open issue: reconcile the Cost Plan's flat labor rate with role-based resource estimates.	Parking operators provide accurate location, availability, pricing and policy data. Approved feeds or labeled test data support development. Mapping, payment and notification providers supply API access and sandboxes. Users have internet and location access when needed. Development resources and funding are available as needed. Delivery must meet the fixed project end date. Security, privacy, payment and city requirements constrain the design. The sponsor provides business direction and designates a representative for approvals.

Financials		
Current planning estimate (USD)	$353,300	Initial development estimate based on the current Cost Plan. Funding and resources are available as needed. Track actual costs and review estimate changes with the sponsor.
Estimated labor: $238,720 for 3,168 hours, matching the role-based Resource Plan. Cost Plan line items sum to $353,300. Its flat $75 labor rate would yield $237,600 and should be reconciled with the role-based rates before approval.		

Milestones Schedule		
Milestone	**Target Completion**	**Actual Date**
Requirements, scope and competitive analysis approved	Initiation phase	September 11, 2026
Architecture, designs and delivery plans approved	Design phase	September 25, 2026
Web/mobile applications and service integrations complete	Development phase	October, 30, 2026
System testing and stakeholder acceptance complete	Before launch	November 20, 2026
Production deployment and operations handover	Project end date	December 4, 2026

Project Team		Approval / Review Committee	
Project Manager	Sean Bar-Tal — coordinate plans, risks, schedule and reporting.	**Project Sponsor**	City of Houston Public Transportation Department
Functional Roles	UX/UI, Web, Mobile, Backend/API, Mapping/Payment, QA, DevOps/Security.	**Scope / Acceptance**	PO/BA owns scope and acceptance criteria. Sponsor representatives, parking operators and billing personnel review business readiness.
External Participants	Drivers/mobile users, parking operators, city representatives, system administrators, finance and external service providers.	**Project Authorization**	Upon sponsor approval, the PM may direct assigned resources and coordinate delivery within the approved scope. Charter approval pending.